WAVERLEY GATEWAY GUIDE

Connecting International Capital with Emerging & Frontier Markets

TRINIDAD AND TOBAGO

Americas

Information current as of October 2026

Dialogue | Trust | Partnership

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WHERE AND HOW TO ENTER

KEY INVESTMENT LOCATIONS

Location / Region	Strategic Importance	Priority Sectors
Port of Spain	Capital and commercial centre; home to the Central Bank, the main banking groups and a containerised port ranked among the top three in the English-speaking Caribbean	Financial services, trade and distribution, professional services
Point Lisas Industrial Estate (Couva)	Gas-based industrial hub for methanol, ammonia and urea; several plants have been preserved in an idled state ready to restart as new gas supply arrives	Petrochemicals, downstream gas, industrial services
Point Fortin (south-west)	Site of Atlantic LNG, with about 12 million tonnes a year of gross capacity across three trains, restructured from 1 May 2027	LNG, gas processing, energy services
Offshore gas basins and the Venezuela border	New fields such as Manatee, Aphrodite, Ginger and Coconut are due on stream in 2027, alongside cross-border Dragon and Manakin-Cocuina gas	Upstream gas, subsea engineering, oilfield services
Special Economic Zones (nationwide)	SEZ regime fully in force since July 2024, offering 15% corporation tax and duty and VAT relief; licensing typically takes three to six months	Nearshore manufacturing, logistics, ICT and data centres
Piarco International Airport and east-west corridor	Main air gateway, about four hours from Miami, with over 20 industrial parks and a science and technology park nearby	Logistics, business process outsourcing, light manufacturing
Tobago	Sister island served by A.N.R. Robinson International Airport, with incentives of up to seven years' tax exemption for qualifying tourism projects	Tourism, hospitality, marinas, eco-tourism

INVESTOR ENTRY ROUTES

- Global Trinidad and Tobago (Global TT), formed in April 2025 by consolidating InvesTT, exporTT and CreativeTT, is the single trade and investment promotion agency for investor facilitation and sector guidance
- Foreign Investment Act 1990 allowing full foreign ownership of private companies (licensing above 30% in public companies), with October 2026 budget amendments simplifying land and share acquisitions up to $100,000

- Special Economic Zones Act 2022, administered by the Special Economic Zones Authority, offering 15% corporation tax, a 150% enhanced initial capital allowance and zero customs duty and VAT on qualifying supplies
- Competitive upstream bid rounds run by the Ministry of Energy and Energy Industries, supported by a 30% petroleum investment tax credit and 140% deepwater allowances
- Central Bank of Trinidad and Tobago oversight of a managed TT dollar; there are no legal restrictions on repatriating earnings or capital, although bank foreign-exchange allocations can involve waiting times
- Investor protection through 12 bilateral investment treaties, 17 double taxation treaties and membership of ICSID, MIGA and the New York Convention
- Sector incentive packages, including tourism tax holidays of up to seven years and a 90% initial capital allowance on manufacturing plant and machinery

MARKET-ENTRY OBSERVATION

Trinidad and Tobago enters late 2026 with strengthening international standing and a clear growth catalyst ahead. S&P reaffirmed the country's investment-grade BBB- rating in July 2026, Moody's moved its Ba2 outlook to stable in June, and the EU removed Trinidad and Tobago from its list of non-cooperative tax jurisdictions in February 2026 after the Free Trade Zone regime was replaced by a modern Special Economic Zone framework. After a contraction of 0.5% in 2025 and a projected 0.2% in 2026, the October 2026 budget projects a return to 2.5% growth in 2027 as new gas fields come on stream. Inflation is low at 0.6% (July 2026), the repo rate has been held at 3.50%, net reserves stood at $5.3 billion (6.1 months of import cover) in August 2026, and the Heritage and Stabilisation Fund held about $6.1 billion. Net FDI flows have been negative as energy companies restructured portfolios, but announced greenfield investment rose to $1.76 billion across seven projects in 2025, and a 2025 shallow-water bid round secured $1.08 billion in commitments.

The country's main structural challenge is natural gas supply. Output from mature fields has declined, leaving Point Lisas with tight supply: Methanex announced in June 2026 the idling of its 860,000-tonne Titan methanol plant, with its Atlas plant already preserved, and Nutrien closed its ammonia and urea operations, reducing export and foreign-exchange earnings. Trinidad and Tobago is meeting this with a concentrated pipeline of new supply: Shell's Manatee (peak about 104,000 boe/d) and Aphrodite, and bp's Ginger and Coconut, all target first gas in 2027, while US licences issued in October 2025 and February 2026, together with a Shell framework agreement with Venezuela in March 2026, have reopened cross-border gas, with Dragon expected to add about 350 million cubic feet a day from late 2027. Idled plants have been preserved for restart, so returning gas can translate quickly into higher exports, and investors entering now can position for the 2027–28 upswing in gas, petrochemicals and energy services.

INVESTOR RISK & MARKET ACCESS

KEY ENTRY BARRIERS

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
Natural gas supply constraints	Declining mature-field output has led to plant idlings at Point Lisas and weighed on growth and export earnings in 2025–26	A wave of new fields due in 2027 and preserved, restart-ready plants create entry points for gas, petrochemical and services investors ahead of the recovery
Foreign-exchange availability	Businesses report waiting times for US dollars through banks, and the IMF projects reserves easing to about 5.5 months of imports in 2026	Exporters and SEZ projects earning hard currency are naturally hedged; agree FX arrangements with banks early, supported by an IMF-backed path toward better market functioning
US sanctions on Venezuela (cross-border gas)	Cross-border gas projects require specific US Treasury (OFAC) authorisation, and initial licences cover negotiation rather than production	Engage only within the scope of issued licences, with sanctions counsel; the October 2025 and February 2026 licences show a clear, lawful route forward
Concentration on energy	Energy accounts for about half of GDP and around 80% of export earnings, linking growth to gas output and prices	SEZ incentives and the Revitalisation Blueprint support nearshore manufacturing, logistics, ICT and tourism as diversification opportunities
Fiscal position and public debt	Gross public sector debt was 86.5% of GDP in June 2026, after a deficit of 5.5%	The FY2027 budget targets a deficit of 2.1% of GDP, backed by the Heritage and

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
	of GDP in 2025	Stabilisation Fund and a stable Moody's outlook
Bureaucracy and slow courts	Investors cite inefficient procedures, and court processes can be slow for domestic and foreign parties alike	Use Global TT and SEZA facilitation, and structure contracts with international arbitration under ICSID and the New York Convention

INVESTOR RISK NOTE

Trinidad and Tobago's risk profile is that of an established, investment-grade energy economy at a turning point. Gas supply has tightened as mature fields decline, which has idled some Point Lisas capacity and placed pressure on foreign-exchange availability, but the response is concrete: several major fields are scheduled for first gas in 2027, cross-border Venezuelan gas has been reopened under specific US licences, and the budget projects growth of 2.5% in 2027. Strong buffers, including $5.3 billion in net reserves and the Heritage and Stabilisation Fund, the S&P reaffirmation, Moody's stable outlook and removal from the EU tax list all support confidence. Investors should treat any Venezuela-linked activity as a compliance matter, proceeding only within issued OFAC licences and with sanctions counsel, and should plan foreign-exchange needs early; those that do are well placed to benefit from the coming recovery in gas output.

MARKET ACCESS

Trinidad and Tobago is a member of CARICOM and its common market, giving preferential access to Caribbean partners, with further CARICOM preferences in Cuba, the Dominican Republic, Venezuela, Colombia and Costa Rica, and is a WTO member. It trades with Europe under the CARIFORUM-EU Economic Partnership Agreement and the UK-CARIFORUM agreement, with Canada under CARIBCAN and with the United States under the Caribbean Basin Economic Recovery Act, and is negotiating agreements with Chile and Curaçao. Energy and petrochemical exports such as LNG, ammonia, urea and methanol account for around 80% of export earnings, while agricultural and food exports go chiefly to the United States, Jamaica, Guyana, Barbados and Suriname. Growing energy cooperation with Guyana, Suriname and Venezuela reinforces the country's role as the Caribbean's gas-processing and energy-services hub.

WHO SHOULD THE INVESTOR MEET?

INSTITUTIONAL LANDSCAPE

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Office of the Prime Minister (Kamla Persad-Bissessar)	Leads the government elected in April 2025 and sets economic policy, including energy diplomacy with Venezuela and the United States	Primary reference point for strategic direction and major project priorities
Global Trinidad and Tobago (Global TT)	Consolidated trade and investment promotion agency combining the former InvesTT, exporTT and CreativeTT	Standard first point of contact for market entry and incentive guidance
Central Bank of Trinidad and Tobago	Sets the repo rate (3.50%) and manages the TT dollar and foreign-exchange support to banks	Relevant for currency, banking and foreign-exchange planning
Ministry of Finance (Davendranath Tancoo)	Leads fiscal policy, the Heritage and Stabilisation Fund and amendments to the Foreign Investment and Exchange Control Acts	Key counterpart on tax, incentives and investment-law changes
Ministry of Energy and Energy Industries (Roodal Moonilal)	Runs upstream bid rounds and leads cross-border gas negotiations with Venezuela	Essential for upstream licensing and energy-sector engagement
National Gas Company (NGC)	State gas aggregator and partner in the Dragon project, central to gas supply contracts for Point Lisas	Core counterpart for gas supply and downstream investment

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Special Economic Zones Authority (SEZA)	Licenses and regulates SEZ operators and enterprises under the 2022 Act	Gateway for manufacturing, logistics and ICT projects seeking SEZ incentives

CURRENT INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS CHANNELS

The Trinidad and Tobago Chamber of Industry and Commerce and the Energy Chamber of Trinidad and Tobago are the principal business associations, with the Energy Chamber the leading voice for operators, contractors and service providers at Point Lisas and offshore. Global TT runs investor outreach and sector programmes, and the Ministry of Trade, Investment and Tourism's investments team supports project facilitation. International energy companies including Shell, bp and EOG Resources maintain major in-country operations and are a useful source of practical intelligence on the gas outlook. The Inter-American Development Bank and the IMF engage closely on economic reform, while the EU Delegation supports trade under the CARIFORUM-EU agreement.

INVESTOR PROFILE BEST SUITED

Trinidad and Tobago suits investors positioning for the 2027–28 recovery in gas output: upstream and oilfield-services companies, subsea engineering firms and petrochemical investors able to take advantage of preserved, restart-ready capacity at Point Lisas. Nearshore manufacturers, logistics and bunkering operators, and ICT and business process outsourcing firms can benefit from the 15% SEZ tax rate, an English-speaking workforce with 98.8% literacy and proximity to North American markets. Tourism and hospitality investors can draw on generous incentives in Tobago. Export-oriented businesses earning hard currency are especially well placed, while investors with Venezuela-linked interests should work within OFAC licences and with specialist counsel.

FROM INTELLIGENCE TO ENGAGEMENT

STEP 1: Engage Global TT and the SEZ Authority on entry and incentives
Use the consolidated investment agency and SEZA to confirm eligibility for the 15% SEZ tax rate, capital allowances and sector incentives before committing capital.

STEP 2: Map the 2027 gas pipeline against your investment case
Track first-gas timelines for Manatee, Aphrodite, Ginger, Coconut and Dragon, and engage NGC early on supply for any gas-dependent project.

STEP 3: Plan foreign-exchange arrangements from the outset
Agree FX access with local banks, favour export or hard-currency revenue streams where possible, and follow Central Bank reforms to the FX market.

STEP 4: Take sanctions advice on any Venezuela-linked activity
Confirm the scope of applicable OFAC licences with specialist counsel before engaging in cross-border gas projects or with Venezuelan counterparts.

STEP 5: Structure contracts for legal certainty
Use bilateral investment treaty protections and international arbitration clauses, and monitor October 2026 amendments to the Foreign Investment Act.